

Kaitlin Wright Esposito

From: Lisa Walsh <jojalis@yahoo.com>
Sent: Wednesday, August 26, 2026 7:43 AM
To: CityClerk
Subject: Formal Opposition to BESS Overlay Expansion – Protect Hilldale Ave Residential Neighborhoods

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Dear President and Members of the Haverhill City Council,

My name is Joe Walsh, a resident of 26 Dawn Circle, which sits adjacent to the 16-acre industrial parcel at 1050 Hilldale Avenue. I am writing to express my strong opposition to any expansion of the proposed Battery Energy Storage Systems (BESS) zoning overlay district into the Upper Hilldale Avenue corridor.

Our neighborhood has already absorbed an overwhelming amount of industrial and commercial development over the years. The existing industrial operations, the massive solar farm right behind my house, heavy traffic - including truck "Jake braking" - noises from the trucking school, are already directly impacting my daily quality of life, specifically through constant, disruptive noise and loss of open space.

Bulldozing acres of woods for massive parking lots on Hilldale has already diminished acoustic screens that used to dampen the persistent roar of traffic from Rt 495. Removing even more mature trees and wooded buffers for a battery storage plant will further degrade the noise barrier. As it is now, highway traffic can be heard in my neighborhood most days and nights.

BESS installations rely on heavy-duty, continuous HVAC cooling systems and inverters that generate a persistent, low-frequency hum. Introducing a BESS facility or expanded industrial utility footprint right around the corner from our homes will make the noise levels in our neighborhood completely unbearable.

During the upcoming September 15 public hearing, I strongly urge the City Council to restrict the BESS overlay district strictly to isolated locations in Haverhill - or none at all. Please do not establish secondary zones or expand definitions that allow these industrial utility installations near established residential areas like Hilldale Avenue and Dawn Circle. Our neighborhood has already given enough.

Thank you for your time, your leadership, and your commitment to protecting the peace and well-being of Haverhill's residents.

I request that my opposition be entered into the official record for the September 15 City Council meeting.

Joe Walsh